

INSTITUTION TYPE GUIDE

Office Manual

Running a company, clinic, church, or organisation on the attendance system

Office administrators and HR staff

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Contents

1. What an office account looks like
2. Setting up, in the right order
3. Terminology you can change
4. Periods and holidays
5. Your people
6. Scoped accounts for supervisors
7. Getting data out
8. Everyday problems
9. Device quick reference

1. What an office account looks like

An office account tracks the people who work for you by fingerprint. It is the general-purpose type — use it for a company, clinic, NGO, church, factory, or any organisation that needs a reliable record of who was present.

Your sidebar has:

- **Attendance** — all scan records, filterable and exportable
- **Members** and / or **Staff** — your people
- **Periods & Holidays** — reporting periods and non-working days
- **Devices, Enrollment, Accounts, Settings**

An office account has no academic terms and no year-end promotion — those are school-only. Everything else works the same way.

1.1 Two ways to record a day

Set this under **Settings** → **Scan mode**. It is the single most important choice you make at setup.

Mode	How it works	Use it when
Present / absent	One scan marks the person present for the day.	You only need to know who showed up.
Time in / time out	First scan is arrival, second is departure. Both appear on one row.	You need hours, lateness, or early departures.

You can set this separately for members and for staff.

TIP

Start with **Present / absent** unless you have a concrete reason to track hours. It is far less disruptive at the door, and you can switch later.

2. Setting up, in the right order

1. **Settings** — name, logo, timezone, scan mode, and **Days tracked** (untick Sat and Sun if you are a Monday-to-Friday operation).

2. **Periods & Holidays** — create your current reporting period and add your public holidays.
3. **Devices** — assign each scanner to the department and location it sits in.
4. **Members / Staff** — add your people, or import them from a spreadsheet.
5. **Enrollment** — enrol each person's fingerprint.
6. **Accounts** — create logins for HR, department heads, and supervisors.

IMPORTANT

Decide your scan mode before you enrol anyone. Switching from present/absent to time in/out partway through a period leaves you with two different shapes of record in the same report.

3. Terminology you can change

The defaults are Member, Group, and Unit. Most offices rename them under **Settings** → **Custom labels**:

Default	An office usually calls it
Member / Members	Employee / Employees, or Staff
Group	Department or Division
Unit	Team, Branch, or Site
Period	Quarter, Month, or Year

Renaming is cosmetic — it changes wording throughout the dashboard and in CSV export headings, and nothing about the data. Adjust it whenever you like.

3.1 Members, staff, or both

Two rosters are available and you control which appear:

- Most offices use **one** roster for everybody. Turn on **Track staff** only.
- Use both when you have two genuinely different populations — for example a clinic tracking employees on one roster and volunteers on the other, with different scan modes.

If you only track staff, the Members section disappears and attendance columns label themselves accordingly.

4. Periods and holidays

4.1 Periods

Go to **Periods & Holidays** and create a period with its name, year, and start and end dates. Mark the current one **Active**.

A period is simply a reporting bucket — a quarter, a month, or a full year, whatever matches how you report. Keep exactly one active at a time. Attendance is tied to whichever period was active when the scan happened.

4.2 Holidays

Add every non-working day: public holidays, company shutdowns, stocktaking days. Nobody is marked absent on those dates.

Tick **Recurring** for holidays on the same calendar date each year. Leave it unticked for dates that move.

The **Days tracked** selector in Settings handles Saturday and Sunday for you — untick the days you are closed rather than adding them as holidays one by one.

5. Your people

5.1 Adding one person

Go to **Staff** (or **Members**), press **Add**, and fill in the ID number, full name, group, and unit.

5.2 Importing a spreadsheet

Press **Import CSV**.

1. Download the template.
2. Fill in one row per person — ID, full name, and unit.
3. Upload it and review the preview. It flags any row with a missing field or an unrecognised unit before anything is created.
4. Confirm.

Imported people start inactive because they have no fingerprint yet. Enrol each one, then set them Active. Only active people are included in the nightly absence run.

5.3 Leavers

Set someone **inactive** rather than deleting them. Their history is preserved and they stop generating absences from that day. Deleting removes their records permanently and cannot be undone.

NOTE

Deactivate a leaver on their last day. If you forget, they accumulate absences that distort your reports until you notice.

6. Scoped accounts for supervisors

A **teacher / staff** account is read-only and limited to one unit. In an office this is your department head or shift supervisor: they can see and export their own team's attendance and nothing else.

Assign the account to a unit when you create it under **Accounts**. That assignment is what scopes their view, including their CSV exports.

7. Getting data out

Go to **Attendance**, apply your filters — date range, period, unit, person, scan type — and press **Export CSV**. The file opens in Excel or Google Sheets.

This is how attendance feeds payroll. Filter to the pay period and the department, export, and hand it over.

In time in / time out mode, both times for a person on a given day appear on the same row, which is what makes hours easy to compute in the spreadsheet.

8. Everyday problems

Problem	What to do
Everyone marked absent on a working day	A holiday was set by mistake, or the device was offline all day. Check both.
Everyone marked absent on a weekend	Sat / Sun are still ticked under Days tracked in Settings. Untick them.
Someone absent but they were at work	They did not scan, or scanned at a device outside their unit.
Time out recorded but no time in	Their first scan of the day did not register. Check the device screen for "NO MATCH".
A leaver still shows absences	They were never set Inactive.
Supervisor sees nothing	Their account has no unit assigned, or the wrong one.
Import rejects rows	Missing field, or a unit name that does not match your devices.

9. Device quick reference

Screen shows	Meaning
Clock and device name	Normal, waiting for a scan
A name, then Present / Time In / Time Out	Scan recognised and recorded
A name and "Offline"	Recognised, but no internet — saved and will upload itself
"COOLDOWN" and a name	Same person scanned again within a minute. Normal.
"NO MATCH"	Finger not recognised. Try again.
A "queued" count under the clock	That many scans are waiting for the internet to return
"PENDING" and a MAC address	Device not yet assigned
"OTA UPDATE" / "Do not unplug"	Installing an update. Leave it powered on.

Light	Meaning
Solid blue	Ready, online
Solid purple	Ready, but no WiFi
Green flash	Scan accepted
Red flash	Not recognised
Solid yellow	Waiting for a finger during enrollment
Breathing yellow	Waiting to be assigned
Breathing red	Installing an update — do not unplug

TIP

A device that has lost WiFi keeps working. It stores scans locally and uploads them when the connection returns, so an internet outage never costs you a day's records.